# PITCH DECK GUIDANCE

# General Guidance

Your goal is to demonstrate:

- Who will buy it and why? You've identified real customer pain + why now?
- Do we make money? Make it clear that you have a profitable solution.

- How much can we sell? Show the problem represents a "unicorn" opportunity.
- Can we defend the profits? Illustrate how you will build a moat.
- Do we have the skills to succeed? Convince investors you have the right team.

# What You Need to Prepare

- **Bios for key team members** – *1, 15 and 60 minutes*
- **Deck** – *5 slides for outreach, 15 slide full pitch, 15 slide appendix*
- **A list of questions YOU will ask THEM** – *do your research*
- (If Relevant) **Advisors / Board Members** – *show value-add*
- **Personal references** for key team members – *5 each*
- **Customer references** – *speak to the importance of the product*

# Suggested Slide Order

1. Cover
2. Vision
3. Problem
4. Solution
5. Team & Advisors
6. How it Works
7. Market
8. Business Model
9. KPIs & Traction
10. Competition
11. Go-to-Market
12. Roadmap
13. Financials
14. Financing & Milestones

# Tell YOUR Story

- **The first 5 minutes are critical** – don't waste that important time.
- **Seed-stage investors back people, first**. Spend time on your story.
- Position your experience relative to the **qualities investors value**.

- **At Pillar VC, these founder qualities are**:
  - Blow through walls resilience
  - Self-awareness and curiosity
  - The ability to create momentum

# In the Meeting

- The first 5 minutes are critical for establishing rapport & interest
- Ask how much time they have for you
- Spend plenty of time on your personal story
- Listen to their questions, do your best to address them, ask if you have.
- It's ok to say, "*I'm not sure – let me work on that.*"
- Keep your demo tight or, even better, pre-record it.
- Ask how things will progress if they like it.

# Pitch Deck
# Content Presentation

# [Company Name]

[Website]

[Contact Email]

# A big, bold, mission statement about how your company is transforming the world.

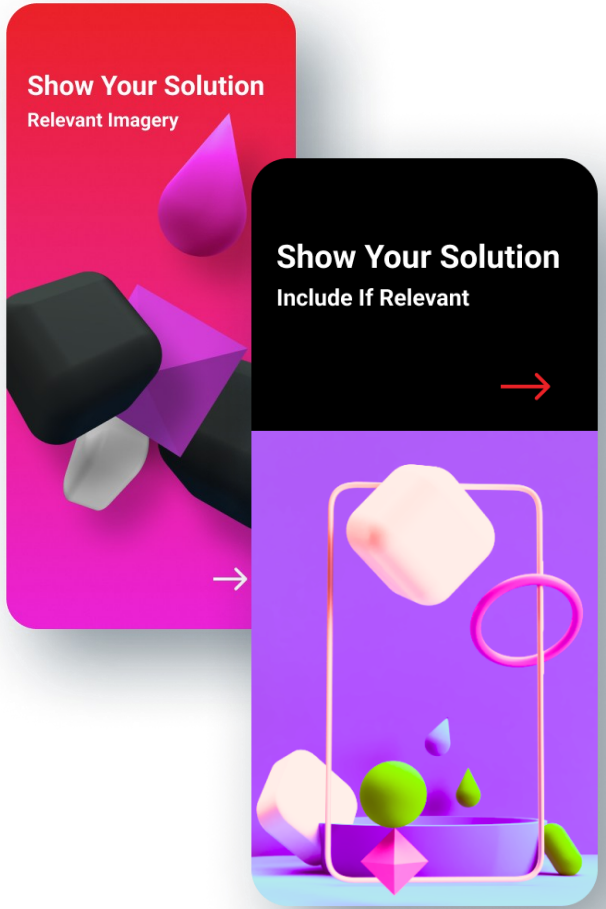
This is your first opportunity to grab an investor’s attention.

# Problem Statement

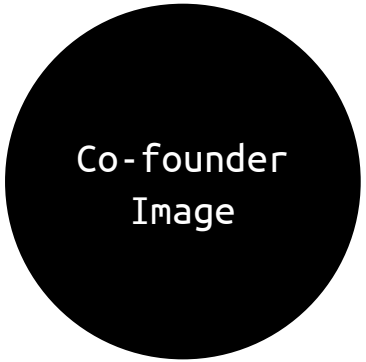
- Describe a customer’s searing pain.
- What is the problem? How big is it?
- How are they solving the problem today?
- How much time, money, energy and they investing in solving the problem?

# Solution

- What is your solution to the problem?
- Why is it faster, better, cheaper, more effective?
- i.e. *how* does it solve the problem?
- Keep it simple. Hook an investor’s interest; let them ask questions.
- Feel free to show graphics or visuals that *show* your solution.

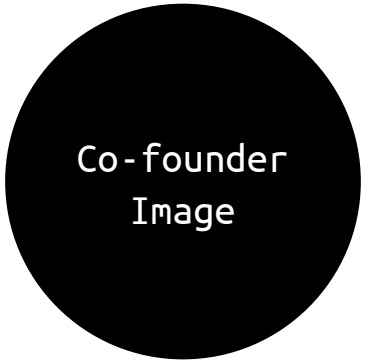


# Team



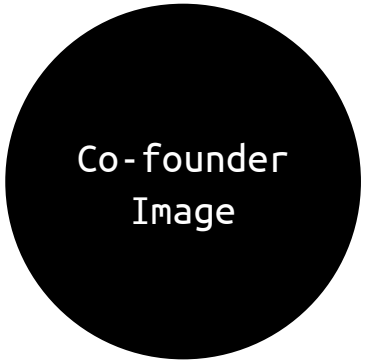

**Name**
Title
Descriptive statement

**logos**




**Name**
Title
Descriptive statement

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# Advisors




**Name**
Title
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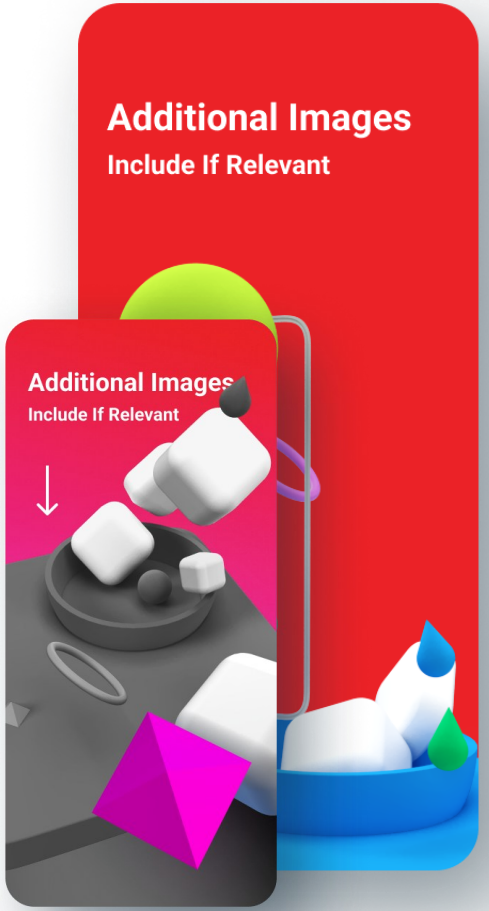



**Name**
Title
Descriptive statement

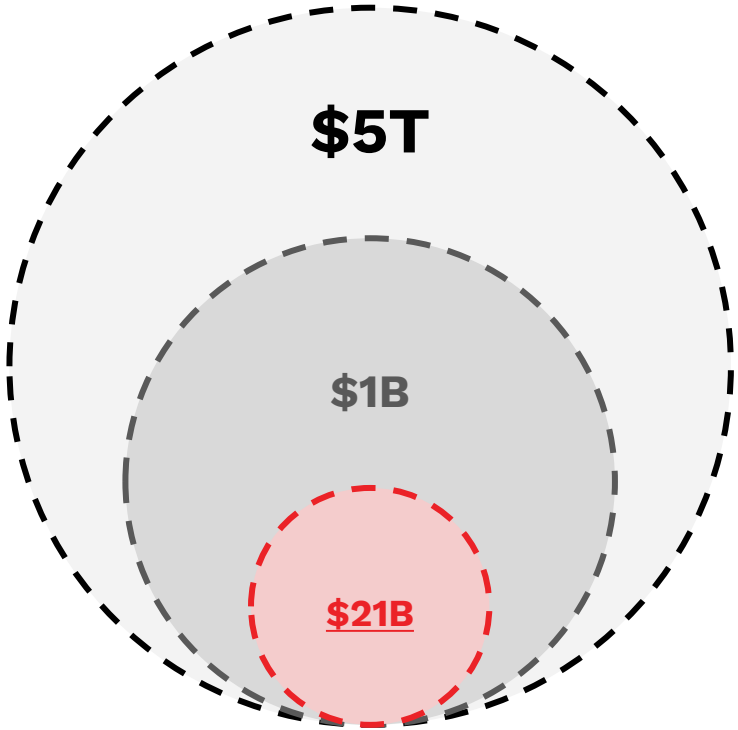
**logos**

# How It Works

- A deeper more detailed description of your solution.
- This is still relatively high-level.
- Feel free to include additional images and technical info.
- Don’t get *too* technical — let investors lead with their questions.
- If you’re planning to demo, pre-record your demo.



# Market




**TAM:** Total Addressable Market

"The $5T travel market"

**SAM:** Serviceable Available Market

"Short term room rental, second home rental, bed and breakfast"

**SOM:** Serviceable Obtainable Market

"Online marketplace model; customer acquisition through online booking"

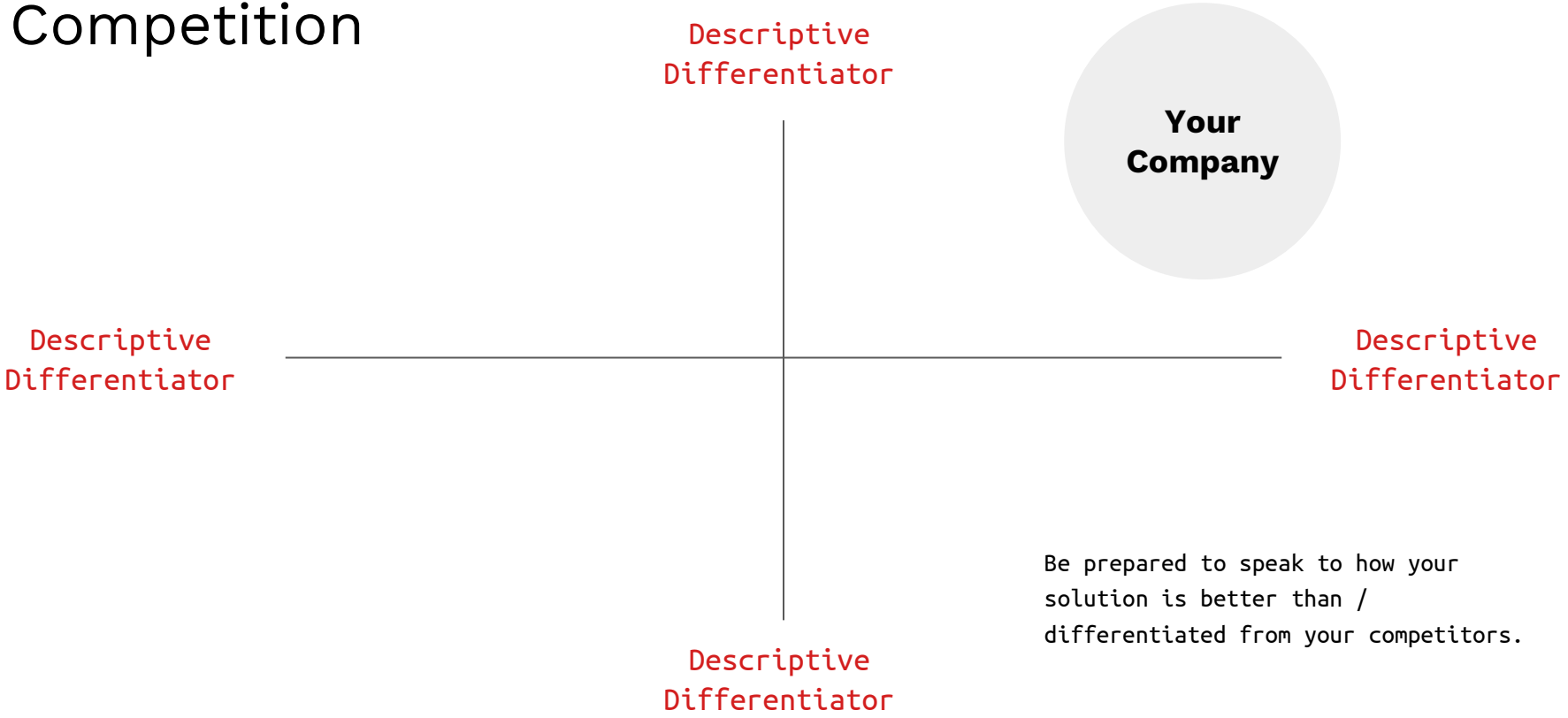
# Business Model

- How does your company make money?
- Pricing details
- Units economics
- Metrics you look to as measures of success
- Share how your company can be profitable over time

# KPIs

- Proof points around early traction.
- Pre-seed/seed-stage examples could include:
  - List signups
  - Early conversion data
  - Pilot data points
  - Sales pipeline
  - Customer feedback

# Competition



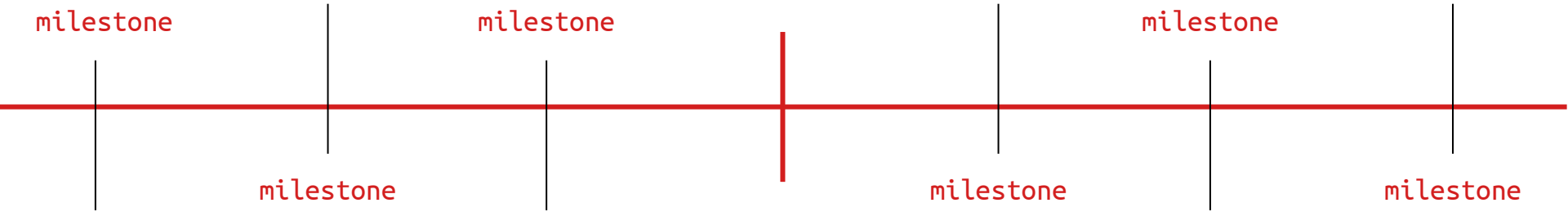

Be prepared to speak to how your solution is better than / differentiated from your competitors.

# Go to Market

- Who is your target customer?
- What is your customer acquisition approach?
- What are key drivers and potential milestones?
- Have you run any tests to validate your assumptions?

# Roadmap

- Timeline of upcoming product and customer milestones
- Helpful to see ~18 months or the timeline your funding will power



# Financials

In addition to the below, you'll want to have a detailed, 5-Year Financial plan ready to open in case an investor asks.

| Summary | | Q1 | Q2 | Q3 | Q4 | Year |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Revenue | | 1,700 | 3,900 | 5,200 | 6,700 | 17,500 |
| COGS | | 15,200 | 26,800 | 41,525 | 61,275 | 144,800 |
| Gross Margin | | (13,500) | (22,900) | (36,325) | (54,575) | (127,300) |
| | | | | | | |
| Beginning Cash Balance | | 1,500,000 | 1,067,995 | 550,160 | 992,918 | 1,500,000 |
| Ending Cash Balance | | 1,067,995 | 550,160 | 992,918 | 398,613 | 398,613 |
| | | | | | | |
| Burn Rate | | (432,005) | (517,835) | (557,243) | (594,305) | (2,101,388) |
| Total Headcount | | 9 | 11 | 12 | 12 | 12 |

# Financing

- How much have you raised to date?
- How much are you seeking to raise in this round?
- What will you do with the funds
  - Key hires
  - Product improvements
  - Traction and milestones
- How long will your funds last?

# Thank you.